

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12418271
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 16, 2025
Inventor(s)	Kovacic; Stephen Joseph et al.

Raised and recessed frames on bottom and top plates of a BAW resonator

Abstract

A film bulk acoustic wave resonator comprising a piezoelectric film having a central region defining a main active domain in which a main acoustic wave is generated during operation, an upper electrode disposed on a top surface of the piezoelectric film, a lower electrode disposed on a lower surface of the piezoelectric film, a dielectric material layer disposed on a lower surface of the lower electrode, and lower recessed frame regions disposed laterally on opposite sides of the central region, the lower recessed frame regions defined by regions of one of the dielectric material or of the lower electrode having a lesser thickness than the thickness of the one of the dielectric material layer or of the lower electrode in the central region.

Inventors: Kovacic; Stephen Joseph (Newport Beach, CA), Abbott; Benjamin Paul (Irvine, CA)

Applicant: SKYWORKS SOLUTIONS, INC. (Irvine, CA)

Family ID: 1000008821144

Assignee: SKYWORKS SOLUTIONS, INC. (Irvine, CA)

Appl. No.: 17/659031

Filed: April 13, 2022

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20220337219 A1	Oct. 20, 2022

Related U.S. Application Data

us-provisional-application US 63175627 20210416

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: **H03H9/13** (20060101); **H03H3/04** (20060101); **H03H9/17** (20060101); **H03H9/56** (20060101); **H03H9/60** (20060101); H03H3/02 (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **H03H9/132** (20130101); **H03H3/04** (20130101); **H03H9/173** (20130101); **H03H9/564** (20130101); **H03H9/605** (20130101); H03H2003/021 (20130101); H03H2003/0457 (20130101)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: H03H (9/132); H03H (9/173); H03H (9/564); H03H (9/605)

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
7187253	12/2006	Sano et al.	N/A	N/A
9991871	12/2017	Zou et al.	N/A	N/A
2014/0203686	12/2013	Song	310/326	H10N 30/074
2014/0354115	12/2013	Burak	310/348	H03H 9/175
2019/0123708	12/2018	Choy	N/A	H03H 3/02
2020/0083861	12/2019	Matsuo	N/A	H03H 9/564
2020/0099359	12/2019	Shin	N/A	H03H 9/568
2020/0373901	12/2019	Liu et al.	N/A	N/A

Primary Examiner: Outten; Samuel S

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Lando & Anastasi, LLP

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application claims priority under 35 U.S.C. § 119(e) to U.S. Provisional Patent Application Ser. No. 63/175,627, titled “RAISED AND RECESSED FRAMES ON BOTTOM AND TOP PLATES OF A BAW RESONATOR,” filed Apr. 16, 2021, the entire contents of which is incorporated by reference herein for all purposes.

BACKGROUND

Technical Field

(1) Embodiments of this disclosure relate to acoustic wave devices, specifically film bulk acoustic wave resonators and electronic devices and modules including same.

Description of Related Technology

(2) Acoustic wave devices, for example, bulk acoustic wave (BAW) devices may be utilized as components of filters in radio frequency electronic systems. For instance, filters in a radio frequency front end of a mobile phone can include acoustic wave filters. Two acoustic wave filters can be arranged as a duplexer.

SUMMARY

(3) In accordance with one aspect, there is provided a film bulk acoustic wave resonator. The film bulk acoustic wave resonator comprises a piezoelectric film having a central region defining a main active domain in which a main acoustic wave is generated during operation, an upper electrode disposed on a top surface of the piezoelectric film, a lower electrode disposed on a lower surface of the piezoelectric film, a dielectric material layer disposed on a lower surface of the lower electrode, and lower recessed frame regions disposed laterally on opposite sides of the central region, the lower recessed frame regions defined by regions of one of the dielectric material or of the lower electrode having a lesser thickness than the thickness of the one of the dielectric material layer or of the lower electrode in the central region.

(4) In some embodiments, the film bulk acoustic wave resonator further comprises lower raised frame regions disposed laterally on opposite sides of the recessed frame regions from the central region, the lower raised frame regions defined by regions of one of the dielectric material or of the lower electrode having a greater thickness than the thickness of the one of the dielectric material layer or of the lower electrode in the central region to improve performance of the film bulk acoustic wave resonator.

(5) In some embodiments, the thickness of the lower electrode in the raised frame regions is greater than the thickness of the lower electrode in the lower recessed frame regions.

(6) In some embodiments, the thickness of the lower electrode in the lower raised frame regions is greater than the thickness of the lower electrode in the central region.

(7) In some embodiments, the thickness of the dielectric material layer in the lower recessed frame regions is less than the thickness of the dielectric material layer in the central region.

(8) In some embodiments, the thickness of the dielectric material layer in the lower raised frame regions is less than the thickness of the dielectric material layer in the central region.

(9) In some embodiments, the thickness of the lower electrode in the central region is greater than the thickness of the lower electrode in the lower recessed frame regions.

(10) In some embodiments, a width of the raised frame region is linearly apodized across a width of the film bulk acoustic wave resonator in a plane defined by the top surface of the piezoelectric film.

(11) In some embodiments, apodization of the raised frame region is between first and second widths on both of a first side of the film bulk acoustic wave resonator and on a second side of the film bulk acoustic wave resonator opposite the first side.

(12) In some embodiments, apodization of the raised frame region is between first and second widths on a first side of the film bulk acoustic wave resonator and between third and fourth widths on a second side of the film bulk acoustic wave resonator opposite the first side, at least one of the third and fourth widths being different from each of the first and second widths.

(13) In some embodiments, a width of the recessed frame region is linearly apodized across a width of the film bulk acoustic wave resonator in a plane defined by the top surface of the piezoelectric film.

(14) In some embodiments, apodization of the recessed frame region is between first and second widths on both of a first side of the film bulk acoustic wave resonator and on a second side of the film bulk acoustic wave resonator opposite the first side.

(15) In some embodiments, apodization of the recessed frame region is between first and second widths on a first side of the film bulk acoustic wave resonator and between third and fourth widths on a second side of the film bulk acoustic wave resonator opposite the first side, at least one of the third and fourth widths being different from each of the first and second widths.

(16) In some embodiments, the piezoelectric film is substantially planar and the central region is disposed over a cavity defined in a support substrate.

(17) In some embodiments, the lower recessed frame regions and lower raised frame regions are also disposed over the cavity defined in the support substrate.

(18) In some embodiments, the upper electrode is thicker than the lower electrode.

- (19) In some embodiments, the film bulk acoustic wave resonator further comprises an upper dielectric film disposed on an upper surface of the upper electrode.
- (20) In some embodiments, the film bulk acoustic wave resonator further comprises upper recessed frame regions including regions of the upper dielectric material having a lesser thickness than the thickness of the upper dielectric material in the central region.
- (21) In some embodiments, the film bulk acoustic wave resonator further comprises upper raised frame regions including regions of the upper dielectric material having a greater thickness than the thickness of the upper dielectric material in the central region.
- (22) In some embodiments, the film bulk acoustic wave resonator further comprises upper recessed frame regions including regions of the upper electrode having a lesser thickness than the thickness of the upper electrode in the central region.
- (23) In some embodiments, the film bulk acoustic wave resonator further comprises upper raised frame regions including regions of the upper electrode having a greater thickness than the thickness of the upper electrode in the central region.
- (24) In some embodiments, the film bulk acoustic wave resonator has a mesa structure.
- (25) In some embodiments, an upper dielectric film disposed on an upper surface of the upper electrode, and upper recessed frame regions including regions of the upper dielectric material having a lesser thickness than the thickness of the upper dielectric material in the central region.
- (26) In some embodiments, an upper dielectric film disposed on an upper surface of the upper electrode, and upper raised frame regions including regions of the upper dielectric material having a greater thickness than the thickness of the upper dielectric material in the central region.
- (27) In some embodiments, the film bulk acoustic wave resonator is included in a radio frequency filter.
- (28) In some embodiments, the film bulk acoustic wave resonator is included in an electronic device module.
- (29) In some embodiments, the film bulk acoustic wave resonator is included in an electronic device.
- (30) In accordance with another aspect, there is provided a film bulk acoustic wave resonator. The film bulk acoustic wave resonator comprises a piezoelectric film having a central region defining a main active domain in which a main acoustic wave is generated during operation, an upper electrode disposed on a top surface of the piezoelectric film, a lower electrode disposed on a lower surface of the piezoelectric film, a dielectric material layer disposed on a lower surface of the lower electrode, and lower raised frame regions disposed laterally on opposite sides of the recessed frame regions from the central region, the lower raised frame regions defined by regions of one of the dielectric material or of the lower electrode having a greater thickness than the thickness of the one of the dielectric material layer or of the lower electrode in the central region to improve performance of the film bulk acoustic wave resonator.
- (31) In some embodiments, the film bulk acoustic wave resonator further comprises lower recessed frame regions disposed laterally on opposite sides of the central region, the lower recessed frame regions defined by regions of one of the dielectric material or of the lower electrode having a lesser thickness than the thickness of the one of the dielectric material layer or of the lower electrode in the central region.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) Embodiments of this disclosure will now be described, by way of non-limiting example, with reference to the accompanying drawings.
- (2) FIG. 1 is a cross-sectional view of an example of film bulk acoustic wave resonator;

- (3) FIG. 2 is a schematic plan view of a film bulk acoustic wave resonator having linearly apodized raised frame widths;
- (4) FIG. 3A illustrates a film bulk acoustic wave resonator configuration in which the recessed and raised frame regions are defined by changes in thickness of dielectric material on the top of the piezoelectric film;
- (5) FIG. 3B illustrates a film bulk acoustic wave resonator configuration in which the recessed and raised frame regions are defined by changes in thickness of the dielectric material and the electrode material on the top of the piezoelectric film;
- (6) FIG. 3C illustrates a film bulk acoustic wave resonator configuration in which the recessed and raised frame regions are defined by changes in thickness of the electrode material on the top of the piezoelectric film;
- (7) FIG. 4A illustrates a film bulk acoustic wave resonator configuration in which the recessed and raised frame regions are defined by changes in thickness of dielectric material on the bottom of the piezoelectric film;
- (8) FIG. 4B illustrates a film bulk acoustic wave resonator configuration in which the recessed and raised frame regions are defined by changes in thickness of the dielectric material and the electrode material on the bottom of the piezoelectric film;
- (9) FIG. 4C illustrates a film bulk acoustic wave resonator configuration in which the recessed and raised frame regions are defined by changes in thickness of the electrode material on the bottom of the piezoelectric film;
- (10) FIG. 5 illustrates an example of a film bulk acoustic wave resonator with the recessed and raised frames are defined on the bottom of the piezoelectric film by changes in the thickness of the lower side dielectric layer and having an active area disposed over a cavity defined by substrate etched to form a “swimming pool” structure;
- (11) FIG. 6A illustrates a film bulk acoustic wave resonator configuration in which the recessed and raised frame regions are defined by changes in thickness of the dielectric material on the bottom and top of the piezoelectric film;
- (12) FIG. 6B illustrates a film bulk acoustic wave resonator configuration in which the recessed and raised frame regions are defined by changes in thickness of the electrode material on the bottom and top of the piezoelectric film;
- (13) FIG. 7 illustrates the film bulk acoustic wave resonator configuration of FIG. 6A disposed over a cavity in a substrate etched to form a “swimming pool” cavity structure;
- (14) FIG. 8 illustrates a mesa type film bulk acoustic wave resonator configuration in which the recessed and raised frame regions are defined by changes in thickness of the dielectric material on the bottom and top of the piezoelectric film;
- (15) FIGS. 9A-9I illustrate a process flow for forming a film bulk acoustic wave resonator in accordance with an embodiment disclosed herein;
- (16) FIG. 10 is a schematic diagram of a radio frequency ladder filter;
- (17) FIG. 11 is a block diagram of one example of a filter module that can include one or more acoustic wave elements according to aspects of the present disclosure;
- (18) FIG. 12 is a block diagram of one example of a front-end module that can include one or more filter modules according to aspects of the present disclosure; and
- (19) FIG. 13 is a block diagram of one example of a wireless device including the front-end module of FIG. 12.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF CERTAIN EMBODIMENTS

(20) The following description of certain embodiments presents various descriptions of specific embodiments. However, the innovations described herein can be embodied in a multitude of different ways, for example, as defined and covered by the claims. In this description, reference is made to the drawings where like reference numerals can indicate identical or functionally similar elements. It will be understood that elements illustrated in the figures are not necessarily drawn to

scale and that some intermediate materials or layers are not illustrated. Moreover, it will be understood that certain embodiments can include more elements than illustrated in a drawing and/or a subset of the elements illustrated in a drawing. Further, some embodiments can incorporate any suitable combination of features from two or more drawings.

(21) Film bulk acoustic wave resonators (FBARs) are a form of bulk acoustic wave resonator that generally includes a film of piezoelectric material sandwiched between a top and a bottom electrode and suspended over a cavity that allows for the film of piezoelectric material to vibrate. A signal applied across the top and bottom electrodes causes an acoustic wave to be generated in and travel through the film of piezoelectric material. A FBAR exhibits a frequency response to applied signals with a resonance peak determined by a thickness of the film of piezoelectric material. Ideally, the only acoustic wave that would be generated in a FBAR is a main acoustic wave that would travel through the film of piezoelectric material in a direction perpendicular to layers of conducting material forming the top and bottom electrodes, sometimes referred to as “piston mode” operation. The piezoelectric material of a FBAR, however, typically has a non-zero Poisson's ratio. Compression and relaxation of the piezoelectric material associated with passage of the main acoustic wave may thus cause compression and relaxation of the piezoelectric material in a direction perpendicular to the direction of propagation of the main acoustic wave. The compression and relaxation of the piezoelectric material in the direction perpendicular to the direction of propagation of the main acoustic wave may generate transverse acoustic waves that travel perpendicular to the main acoustic wave (parallel to the surfaces of the electrode films) through the piezoelectric material. The transverse acoustic waves may be reflected back into an area in which the main acoustic wave propagates and may induce spurious acoustic waves travelling in the same direction as the main acoustic wave. These spurious acoustic waves may degrade the frequency response of the FBAR from what is expected or from what is intended and are generally considered undesirable.

(22) FIG. 1 is cross-sectional view of an example of a FBAR, indicated generally at **100**, having what may be referred to as a mesa structure. The FBAR **100** is disposed on a substrate **110**, for example, a silicon substrate that may include a dielectric surface layer **110A** of, for example, silicon dioxide. The FBAR **100** includes a layer or film of piezoelectric material **115**, for example, aluminum nitride (AlN). A top electrode **120** is disposed on top of a portion of the layer or film of piezoelectric material **115** and a bottom electrode **125** is disposed on the bottom of a portion of the layer or film of piezoelectric material **115**. The top electrode **120** may be formed of, for example, ruthenium (Ru), molybdenum (Mo), or a Ru/Mo alloy. The bottom electrode **125** may include a layer **125A** of Ru (or Mo or Ru/Mo alloy) disposed in contact with the bottom of the portion of the layer or film of piezoelectric material **115** and a layer **125B** of titanium (Ti) disposed on a lower side of the layer **125A** of Ru opposite a side of the layer **125A** of Ru in contact with the bottom of the portion of the layer or film of piezoelectric material **115**. Each of the top electrode **120** and the bottom electrode **125** may be covered with a layer of dielectric material **130**, for example, silicon dioxide. A cavity **135** is defined beneath the layer of dielectric material **130** covering the bottom electrode **125** and the surface layer **110A** of the substrate **110**. A bottom electrical contact **140** formed of, for example, copper may make electrical connection with the bottom electrode **125** and a top electrical contact **145** formed of, for example, copper may make electrical connection with the top electrode **120**.

(23) The FBAR **100** may include a central region **150** including a main active domain in the layer or film of piezoelectric material **115** in which a main acoustic wave is excited during operation. The central region **150** may also be referred to as the active area of the FBAR **100**. The central region may have a width of, for example, between about 20 μm and about 100 μm . A recessed frame region or regions **155** may bound and define the lateral extent of the central region **150**. The recessed frame regions may have a width of, for example, about 1 μm . The recessed frame region(s) **155** may be defined by areas that have a thinner layer of dielectric material **130** on top of

the top electrode **120** than in the central region **150**. The dielectric material layer **130** in the recessed frame region(s) **155** may be from about 10 nm to about 100 nm thinner than the dielectric material layer **130** in the central region **150**. The difference in thickness of the dielectric material in the recessed frame region(s) **155** vs. in the central region **150** may cause the resonant frequency of the device in the recessed frame region(s) **155** to be between about 5 MHz to about 50 MHz higher than the resonant frequency of the device in the central region **150**. In some embodiments, the thickness of the dielectric material layer **130** in the central region **150** may be about 200 nm to about 300 nm and the thickness of the dielectric material layer **130** in the recessed frame region(s) **155** may be about 100 nm. The dielectric film **300** in the recessed frame region(s) **155** is typically etched during manufacturing to achieve a desired difference in acoustic velocity between the central region **150** and the recessed frame region(s) **155**. Accordingly, the dielectric film **300** initially deposited in both the central region **150** and recessed frame region(s) **155** is deposited with a sufficient thickness that allows for etching of sufficient dielectric film **300** in the recessed frame region(s) **155** to achieve a desired difference in thickness of the dielectric film **300** in the central region **150** and recessed frame region(s) **155** to achieve a desired acoustic velocity difference between these regions.

(24) A raised frame region or regions **160** may be defined on an opposite side of the recessed frame region(s) **155** from the central region **150** and may directly abut the outside edge(s) of the recessed frame region(s) **155**. The raised frame regions may have widths of, for example, about 1 μm . The raised frame region(s) **160** may be defined by areas where the top electrode **120** is thicker than in the central region **150** and in the recessed frame region(s) **155**. The top electrode **120** may have the same thickness in the central region **150** and in the recessed frame region(s) **155** but a greater thickness in the raised frame region(s) **160**. The top electrode **120** may be between about 50 nm and about 500 nm thicker in the raised frame region(s) **160** than in the central region **150** and/or in the recessed frame region(s) **155**. In some embodiments the thickness of the top electrode in the central region may be between 50 and 500 nm. In other embodiments, the top electrode **120** may have the same thickness in the central region **150**, the recessed frame region(s) **155**, and the raised frame region(s) **160**, and the raised frame may be defined by a thicker layer of dielectric film **300** in the raised frame regions than in the central region **150** and recessed frame region(s) **155**.

(25) The recessed frame region(s) **155** and the raised frame region(s) **160** may contribute to dissipation or scattering of transverse acoustic waves generated in the FBAR **100** during operation and/or may reflect transverse waves propagating outside of the recessed frame region(s) **155** and the raised frame region(s) **160** and prevent these transverse acoustic waves from entering the central region and inducing spurious signals in the main active domain region of the FBAR. Without being bound to a particular theory, it is believed that due to the thinner layer of dielectric material **130** on top of the top electrode **120** in the recessed frame region(s) **155**, the recessed frame region(s) **155** may exhibit a higher velocity of propagation of acoustic waves than the central region **150**. Conversely, due to the increased thickness and mass of the top electrode **120** in the raised frame region(s) **160**, the raised frame regions(s) **160** may exhibit a lower velocity of propagation of acoustic waves than the central region **150** and a lower velocity of propagation of acoustic waves than the recessed frame region(s) **155**. The discontinuity in acoustic wave velocity between the recessed frame region(s) **155** and the raised frame region(s) **160** creates a barrier that scatters, suppresses, and/or reflects transverse acoustic waves.

(26) In some embodiments, to prevent or reduce the tendency of transverse acoustic waves to form or to resonate and form standing waves in the central region/active area **150** of an FBAR, the raised frame width (RaW) may be linearly apodized between two values at each corner or side of the resonator. The discrete RaW may take on four values to provide a diversity of responses along each edge. FIG. 2 provides an example of this configuration.

(27) The border and overall shape of the FBAR as a whole may be rectangular or square, but the raised frame **160** may have different widths $\delta_{\text{sub.1}}$, $\delta_{\text{sub.2}}$, $\delta_{\text{sub.3}}$, $\delta_{\text{sub.4}}$ in the X and Y axes in

the plane of the substrate or piezoelectric film in different corners of the FBAR. The width of the raised frame **160** may linearly vary between the different widths at each corner along the sides of the FBAR. The width of the recessed frame **155** (ReW) may be constant about the active area **150**. The central region/active area **150** may thus vary in width along both the X and Y axes of the FBAR, which will make it difficult for any spurious transverse waves to establish resonance or standing waves in the central region/active area **150**.

(28) As discussed above with reference to FIG. **1**, the raised and recessed frame regions may be formed by changes in thickness of the electrode material **120** and/or dielectric material **130** on the top of the piezoelectric film **115** of a FBAR opposite the side of the piezoelectric film facing the cavity **135**. FIG. **3A** illustrates how the recessed and raised frame regions may be defined by changes in thickness of the dielectric material **130** (for example, SiO.sub.2) on the top of the piezoelectric film **115**. FIG. **3B** illustrates how the recessed and raised frame regions may be defined by changes in thickness of the dielectric material **130** (for example, SiO.sub.2) and the electrode material **120** on the top of the piezoelectric film **115**. FIG. **3C** illustrates how the recessed and raised frame regions may be defined by changes in thickness of the electrode material **120** on the top of the piezoelectric film **115**. In other embodiments, the dielectric material of FIG. **3A** or **3B** could be replaced by or supplemented with any other layer or material that imparts the benefit realizing a different acoustic resonance condition relative to the center of the resonator.

(29) In other embodiments, the raised frame regions and recessed frame regions may be defined by changes in thickness of the electrode material **120** and/or dielectric material **130** (for example, SiO.sub.2) on the bottom side of the piezoelectric film facing the cavity **135**. FIG. **4A** illustrates a film bulk acoustic wave resonator configuration in which the recessed and raised frame regions may be defined by changes in thickness of dielectric material **130** on the bottom of the piezoelectric film. FIG. **4B** illustrates a film bulk acoustic wave resonator configuration in which the recessed and raised frame regions may be defined by changes in thickness of the dielectric material and the electrode material on the bottom of the piezoelectric film. FIG. **4C** illustrates a film bulk acoustic wave resonator configuration in which the recessed and raised frame regions may be defined by changes in thickness of the electrode material on the bottom of the piezoelectric film. In other embodiments, the dielectric material **130** of FIG. **4A** or **4B** could be replaced by or supplemented with any other layer or material that imparts the benefit realizing a different acoustic resonance condition relative to the center of the resonator.

(30) In some embodiments, instead of forming a FBAR with a mesa structure as illustrated in FIG. **1** in which the piezoelectric film **115** rises up from the substrate **110** to form the flat active area **150** over the cavity **135**, a FBAR may be formed with a substantially planar piezoelectric material film **115** and the cavity **135** may be defined by etching a portion of the substrate **110** below the piezoelectric film **115** to form a “swimming pool” type cavity structure. FIG. **5** illustrates an example of a FBAR with the recessed and raised frames defined on the bottom of the piezoelectric film by changes in the thickness of the lower side dielectric layer and having an active area disposed over a cavity **135** defined by substrate etched to form a “swimming pool” structure. The FBAR of FIG. **5** may be more reliable than FBARs having a mesa structure such as the FBAR illustrated in FIG. **1**. The formation of the piezoelectric layer **115** with the different orientations in a mesa structure may lead to crystallographic defects in the material of the piezoelectric layer **115** that may degrade device performance. Forming a planar piezoelectric layer, as in the embodiment illustrated in FIG. **5**, may help avoid such crystallographic defects. In other embodiments, the dielectric material **130** of FIG. **5** could be replaced by or supplemented with any other layer or material that imparts the benefit realizing a different acoustic resonance condition relative to the center of the resonator.

(31) In further embodiments the raised and recessed frame structures of an FBAR may be formed on both the top and bottom of the piezoelectric film. FIG. **6A** illustrates an example of an FBAR structure in which the raised and recessed frames are defined by different thicknesses of dielectric

on both the upper and lower surfaces of the piezoelectric film. In other embodiments, the dielectric material of FIG. 6A could be replaced by or supplemented with any other layer or material that imparts the benefit realizing a different acoustic resonance condition relative to the center of the resonator. FIG. 6B illustrates an example of an FBAR structure in which the raised and recessed frames are defined by different thicknesses of the electrode material on both the upper and lower surfaces of the piezoelectric film.

(32) An FBAR in which the raised and recessed frame structures of an FBAR may be formed on both the top and bottom of the piezoelectric film may also be disposed on a substrate in which the cavity 135 is formed as a swimming pool structure by etching of the substrate. FIG. 7 illustrates an example of an FBAR structure including a substrate having a swimming pool type cavity 135 in which the raised and recessed frames are defined by different thicknesses of dielectric on both the upper and lower surfaces of the piezoelectric film. A FBAR structure in which the raised and recessed frames are defined by different thicknesses of the electrode material on both the upper and lower surfaces of the piezoelectric film such as illustrated in FIG. 6B could also include a substrate having a swimming pool type cavity 135 as illustrated in FIG. 7.

(33) Any embodiments of FBAR structures disclosed herein in which the raised and recessed frames are defined by different thicknesses of the electrode material or dielectric material on both the upper and lower surfaces of the piezoelectric film may also be used to modify the mesa type FBAR illustrated in FIG. 1. FIG. 8 illustrates a simplified example of a mesa type FBAR having the raised and recessed frames defined by areas of dielectric material having different thicknesses on both the upper and lower sides of the piezoelectric film. The example of FIG. 8 could be modified such that the raised and recessed frames are defined by areas of electrode material having different thicknesses on both the upper and lower sides of the piezoelectric film. In other embodiments, the dielectric material 130 of FIG. 8 could be replaced by or supplemented with any other layer or material that imparts the benefit realizing a different acoustic resonance condition relative to the center of the resonator.

(34) FIGS. 9A-9I illustrate a process flow for forming a film bulk acoustic wave resonator in accordance with an embodiment disclosed herein. The process may begin by providing a silicon substrate as shown in FIG. 9A. A hard or soft mask, for example, photoresist or a dielectric material is then deposited and patterned on the silicon substrate and the silicon substrate is etched to define areas for the raised frame regions (FIG. 9B). Another hard or soft mask is then deposited and patterned and the substrate is etched to define areas for the recessed frame regions (FIG. 9C). The masks are removed and a layer of passivation material, for example, SiO₂, SiN, etc., is deposited over the top of the substrate (FIG. 9D). The passivation material is then polished by CMP to expose the silicon of the substrate at the recessed frame areas (FIG. 9E). A thin layer of etch stop material is deposited and the bottom electrode material is deposited over the etch stop material and patterned (FIG. 9F). The piezoelectric material film is grown on top of the bottom electrode and patterned (FIG. 9G). The top electrode is deposited on top of the piezoelectric material and patterned (FIG. 9H). As discussed above, the top electrode may be formed with a greater thickness than the bottom electrode. The substrate beneath the active area of the piezoelectric film is the etched, for example, by introducing a silicon etching plasma through holes in the piezoelectric material and electrode layers (not shown) to define a cavity beneath the active area (FIG. 9I). An oxide layer may be grown on the silicon defining the bottom of the cavity. Additional process steps could be utilized to form recessed and raised frames on top of the piezoelectric layer by depositing and patterning additional top electrode metal and/or dielectric material on top of the upper electrode using deposition, patterning, and etching processes known in the art to arrive at other structures such as disclosed above.

(35) It should be appreciated that the FBARs illustrated in the figures presented herein are illustrated in a highly simplified form. The relative dimensions of the different features are not shown to scale. Further, typical FBARs may include additional features or layers not illustrated.

(36) In some embodiments, multiple FBARs as disclosed herein may be combined into a filter, for example, an RF ladder filter schematically illustrated in FIG. 10 and including a plurality of series resonators R1, R3, R5, R7, and R9, and a plurality of parallel (or shunt) resonators R2, R4, R6, and R8. As shown, the plurality of series resonators R1, R3, R5, R7, and R9 are connected in series between the input and the output of the RF ladder filter, and the plurality of parallel resonators R2, R4, R6, and R8 are respectively connected between series resonators and ground in a shunt configuration. Other filter structures and other circuit structures known in the art that may include FBAR devices or resonators, for example, duplexers, baluns, etc., may also be formed including examples of FBAR resonators as disclosed herein.

(37) The acoustic wave devices discussed herein can be implemented in a variety of packaged modules. Some example packaged modules will now be discussed in which any suitable principles and advantages of the packaged acoustic wave devices discussed herein can be implemented. FIGS. 11, 12, and 13 are schematic block diagrams of illustrative packaged modules and devices according to certain embodiments.

(38) As discussed above, embodiments of the disclosed FBARs can be configured as or used in filters, for example. In turn, a FBAR filter using one or more FBAR elements may be incorporated into and packaged as a module that may ultimately be used in an electronic device, such as a wireless communications device, for example. FIG. 11 is a block diagram illustrating one example of a module 400 including a FBAR filter 410. The FBAR filter 410 may be implemented on one or more die(s) 420 including one or more connection pads 422. For example, the FBAR filter 410 may include a connection pad 422 that corresponds to an input contact for the FBAR filter and another connection pad 422 that corresponds to an output contact for the FBAR filter. The packaged module 400 includes a packaging substrate 430 that is configured to receive a plurality of components, including the die 420. A plurality of connection pads 432 can be disposed on the packaging substrate 430, and the various connection pads 422 of the FBAR filter die 420 can be connected to the connection pads 432 on the packaging substrate 430 via electrical connectors 434, which can be solder bumps or wirebonds, for example, to allow for passing of various signals to and from the FBAR filter 410. The module 400 may optionally further include other circuitry die 440, such as, for example, one or more additional filter(s), amplifiers, pre-filters, modulators, demodulators, down converters, and the like, as would be known to one of skill in the art of semiconductor fabrication in view of the disclosure herein. In some embodiments, the module 400 can also include one or more packaging structures to, for example, provide protection and facilitate easier handling of the module 400. Such a packaging structure can include an overmold formed over the packaging substrate 430 and dimensioned to substantially encapsulate the various circuits and components thereon.

(39) Various examples and embodiments of the FBAR filter 410 can be used in a wide variety of electronic devices. For example, the FBAR filter 410 can be used in an antenna duplexer, which itself can be incorporated into a variety of electronic devices, such as RF front-end modules and communication devices.

(40) Referring to FIG. 12, there is illustrated a block diagram of one example of a front-end module 500, which may be used in an electronic device such as a wireless communications device (e.g., a mobile phone) for example. The front-end module 500 includes an antenna duplexer 510 having a common node 502, an input node 504, and an output node 506. An antenna 610 is connected to the common node 502.

(41) The antenna duplexer 510 may include one or more transmission filters 512 connected between the input node 504 and the common node 502, and one or more reception filters 514 connected between the common node 502 and the output node 506. The passband(s) of the transmission filter(s) are different from the passband(s) of the reception filter(s). Examples of the FBAR filter 410 can be used to form the transmission filter(s) 512 and/or the reception filter(s) 514. An inductor or other matching component 520 may be connected at the common node 502.

(42) The front-end module **500** further includes a transmitter circuit **532** connected to the input node **504** of the duplexer **510** and a receiver circuit **534** connected to the output node **506** of the duplexer **510**. The transmitter circuit **532** can generate signals for transmission via the antenna **610**, and the receiver circuit **534** can receive and process signals received via the antenna **610**. In some embodiments, the receiver and transmitter circuits are implemented as separate components, as shown in FIG. **12**, however in other embodiments these components may be integrated into a common transceiver circuit or module. As will be appreciated by those skilled in the art, the front-end module **500** may include other components that are not illustrated in FIG. **12** including, but not limited to, switches, electromagnetic couplers, amplifiers, processors, and the like.

(43) FIG. **13** is a block diagram of one example of a wireless device **600** including the antenna duplexer **510** shown in FIG. **12**. The wireless device **600** can be a cellular phone, smart phone, tablet, modem, communication network or any other portable or non-portable device configured for voice or data communication. The wireless device **600** can receive and transmit signals from the antenna **610**. The wireless device includes an embodiment of a front-end module **500** similar to that discussed above with reference to FIG. **12**. The front-end module **500** includes the duplexer **510**, as discussed above. In the example shown in FIG. **13** the front-end module **500** further includes an antenna switch **540**, which can be configured to switch between different frequency bands or modes, such as transmit and receive modes, for example. In the example illustrated in FIG. **13**, the antenna switch **540** is positioned between the duplexer **510** and the antenna **610**; however, in other examples the duplexer **510** can be positioned between the antenna switch **540** and the antenna **610**. In other examples the antenna switch **540** and the duplexer **510** can be integrated into a single component.

(44) The front-end module **500** includes a transceiver **530** that is configured to generate signals for transmission or to process received signals. The transceiver **530** can include the transmitter circuit **532**, which can be connected to the input node **504** of the duplexer **510**, and the receiver circuit **534**, which can be connected to the output node **506** of the duplexer **510**, as shown in the example of FIG. **12**.

(45) Signals generated for transmission by the transmitter circuit **532** are received by a power amplifier (PA) module **550**, which amplifies the generated signals from the transceiver **530**. The power amplifier module **550** can include one or more power amplifiers. The power amplifier module **550** can be used to amplify a wide variety of RF or other frequency-band transmission signals. For example, the power amplifier module **550** can receive an enable signal that can be used to pulse the output of the power amplifier to aid in transmitting a wireless local area network (WLAN) signal or any other suitable pulsed signal. The power amplifier module **550** can be configured to amplify any of a variety of types of signal, including, for example, a Global System for Mobile (GSM) signal, a code division multiple access (CDMA) signal, a W-CDMA signal, a Long-Term Evolution (LTE) signal, or an EDGE signal. In certain embodiments, the power amplifier module **550** and associated components including switches and the like can be fabricated on gallium arsenide (GaAs) substrates using, for example, high-electron mobility transistors (pHEMT) or insulated-gate bipolar transistors (BiFET), or on a Silicon substrate using complementary metal-oxide semiconductor (CMOS) field effect transistors.

(46) Still referring to FIG. **13**, the front-end module **500** may further include a low noise amplifier module **560**, which amplifies received signals from the antenna **610** and provides the amplified signals to the receiver circuit **534** of the transceiver **530**.

(47) The wireless device **600** of FIG. **13** further includes a power management sub-system **620** that is connected to the transceiver **530** and manages the power for the operation of the wireless device **600**. The power management system **620** can also control the operation of a baseband sub-system **630** and various other components of the wireless device **600**. The power management system **620** can include, or can be connected to, a battery (not shown) that supplies power for the various components of the wireless device **600**. The power management system **620** can further include

one or more processors or controllers that can control the transmission of signals, for example. In one embodiment, the baseband sub-system **630** is connected to a user interface **640** to facilitate various input and output of voice and/or data provided to and received from the user. The baseband sub-system **630** can also be connected to memory **650** that is configured to store data and/or instructions to facilitate the operation of the wireless device, and/or to provide storage of information for the user. Any of the embodiments described above can be implemented in association with mobile devices such as cellular handsets. The principles and advantages of the embodiments can be used for any systems or apparatus, such as any uplink wireless communication device, that could benefit from any of the embodiments described herein. The teachings herein are applicable to a variety of systems. Although this disclosure includes some example embodiments, the teachings described herein can be applied to a variety of structures. Any of the principles and advantages discussed herein can be implemented in association with RF circuits configured to process signals in a range from about 30 kHz to 300 GHz, such as in a range from about 450 MHz to 6 GHz.

(48) Aspects of this disclosure can be implemented in various electronic devices. Examples of the electronic devices can include, but are not limited to, consumer electronic products, parts of the consumer electronic products such as packaged radio frequency modules, uplink wireless communication devices, wireless communication infrastructure, electronic test equipment, etc. Examples of the electronic devices can include, but are not limited to, a mobile phone such as a smart phone, a wearable computing device such as a smart watch or an ear piece, a telephone, a television, a computer monitor, a computer, a modem, a hand-held computer, a laptop computer, a tablet computer, a microwave, a refrigerator, a vehicular electronics system such as an automotive electronics system, a stereo system, a digital music player, a radio, a camera such as a digital camera, a portable memory chip, a washer, a dryer, a washer/dryer, a copier, a facsimile machine, a scanner, a multi-functional peripheral device, a wrist watch, a clock, etc. Further, the electronic devices can include unfinished products.

(49) Unless the context clearly requires otherwise, throughout the description and the claims, the words “comprise,” “comprising,” “include,” “including” and the like are to be construed in an inclusive sense, as opposed to an exclusive or exhaustive sense; that is to say, in the sense of “including, but not limited to.” The word “coupled”, as generally used herein, refers to two or more elements that may be either directly connected, or connected by way of one or more intermediate elements. Likewise, the word “connected”, as generally used herein, refers to two or more elements that may be either directly connected, or connected by way of one or more intermediate elements. Additionally, the words “herein,” “above,” “below,” and words of similar import, when used in this application, shall refer to this application as a whole and not to any particular portions of this application. Where the context permits, words in the above Detailed Description using the singular or plural number may also include the plural or singular number respectively. The word “or” in reference to a list of two or more items, that word covers all of the following interpretations of the word: any of the items in the list, all of the items in the list, and any combination of the items in the list.

(50) Moreover, conditional language used herein, such as, among others, “can,” “could,” “might,” “may,” “e.g.,” “for example,” “such as” and the like, unless specifically stated otherwise, or otherwise understood within the context as used, is generally intended to convey that certain embodiments include, while other embodiments do not include, certain features, elements and/or states. Thus, such conditional language is not generally intended to imply that features, elements and/or states are in any way required for one or more embodiments or that one or more embodiments necessarily include logic for deciding, with or without author input or prompting, whether these features, elements and/or states are included or are to be performed in any particular embodiment.

(51) While certain embodiments have been described, these embodiments have been presented by

way of example only, and are not intended to limit the scope of the disclosure. Indeed, the novel apparatus, methods, and systems described herein may be embodied in a variety of other forms; furthermore, various omissions, substitutions and changes in the form of the methods and systems described herein may be made without departing from the spirit of the disclosure. For example, while blocks are presented in a given arrangement, alternative embodiments may perform similar functionalities with different components and/or circuit topologies, and some blocks may be deleted, moved, added, subdivided, combined, and/or modified. Each of these blocks may be implemented in a variety of different ways. Any suitable combination of the elements and acts of the various embodiments described above can be combined to provide further embodiments. The accompanying claims and their equivalents are intended to cover such forms or modifications as would fall within the scope and spirit of the disclosure.

Claims

1. A film bulk acoustic wave resonator comprising: a piezoelectric film having a central region defining a main active domain in which a main acoustic wave is generated during operation; an upper electrode disposed on a top surface of the piezoelectric film; a lower electrode disposed on a lower surface of the piezoelectric film; a dielectric material layer disposed on a lower surface of the lower electrode; a carrier substrate disposed below a lower surface of the dielectric material layer; lower recessed frame regions disposed laterally on opposite sides of the central region, the dielectric material layer disposed on the lower surface of the lower electrode throughout the central region, the lower recessed frame regions, and throughout areas extending between the central region and the lower recessed frame regions, the lower recessed frame regions defined by regions of the dielectric material layer having a lesser thickness than a thickness of the dielectric material layer in the central region; and lower raised frame regions disposed laterally on opposite sides of the lower recessed frame regions from the central region, the lower raised frame regions defined by regions of the lower electrode having a greater thickness than a thickness of the lower electrode in the central region, the dielectric material layer extending throughout the lower raised frame regions and having a thickness in the lower raised frame regions less than the thickness of the dielectric material layer in the central region.
2. The film bulk acoustic wave resonator of claim 1 included in a radio frequency filter.
3. The film bulk acoustic wave resonator of claim 2 included in an electronic device module.
4. The film bulk acoustic wave resonator of claim 3 included in an electronic device.
5. The film bulk acoustic wave resonator of claim 1 wherein widths of the lower raised frame regions are linearly apodized across a width of the film bulk acoustic wave resonator in a plane defined by the top surface of the piezoelectric film.
6. The film bulk acoustic wave resonator of claim 5 wherein apodization of the lower raised frame regions is between first and second widths on both of a first side of the film bulk acoustic wave resonator and on a second side of the film bulk acoustic wave resonator opposite the first side.
7. The film bulk acoustic wave resonator of claim 5 wherein apodization of the lower raised frame regions is between first and second widths on a first side of the film bulk acoustic wave resonator and between third and fourth widths on a second side of the film bulk acoustic wave resonator opposite the first side, at least one of the third and fourth widths being different from each of the first and second widths.
8. The film bulk acoustic wave resonator of claim 1 wherein widths of the lower recessed frame regions are linearly apodized across a width of the film bulk acoustic wave resonator in a plane defined by the top surface of the piezoelectric film.
9. The film bulk acoustic wave resonator of claim 8 wherein apodization of the lower recessed frame regions is between first and second widths on both of a first side of the film bulk acoustic wave resonator and on a second side of the film bulk acoustic wave resonator opposite the first

side.

10. The film bulk acoustic wave resonator of claim 8 wherein apodization of the lower recessed frame regions is between first and second widths on a first side of the film bulk acoustic wave resonator and between third and fourth widths on a second side of the film bulk acoustic wave resonator opposite the first side, at least one of the third and fourth widths being different from each of the first and second widths.

11. The film bulk acoustic wave resonator of claim 1 further comprising an upper dielectric material layer disposed on an upper surface of the upper electrode and upper recessed frame regions including regions of the upper dielectric material layer having a lesser thickness than a thickness of the upper dielectric material layer in the central region.

12. The film bulk acoustic wave resonator of claim 11 further comprising upper raised frame regions including regions of the upper dielectric material layer having a greater thickness than the thickness of the upper dielectric material layer in the central region.

13. The film bulk acoustic wave resonator of claim 1 wherein the thickness of the lower electrode in the lower raised frame regions is greater than the thickness of the lower electrode in the lower recessed frame regions and greater than the thickness of the lower electrode in the central region.

14. The film bulk acoustic wave resonator of claim 1 further comprising upper raised frame regions including regions of the upper electrode having a greater thickness than the thickness of the upper electrode in the central region.

15. The film bulk acoustic wave resonator of claim 1 further comprising an upper dielectric material disposed on an upper surface of the upper electrode, and upper raised frame regions including regions of the upper dielectric material having a greater thickness than a thickness of the upper dielectric material in the central region.

16. A film bulk acoustic wave resonator comprising: a piezoelectric film having a central region defining a main active domain in which a main acoustic wave is generated during operation; an upper electrode disposed on a top surface of the piezoelectric film; a lower electrode disposed on a lower surface of the piezoelectric film; a dielectric material layer disposed on a lower surface of the lower electrode; a carrier substrate disposed below the lower surface of the dielectric material layer; lower recessed frame regions disposed laterally on opposite sides of the central region, the dielectric material layer disposed on the lower surface of the lower electrode throughout the central region, the lower recessed frame regions, and throughout areas extending between the central region and the lower recessed frame regions; and lower raised frame regions disposed laterally on opposite sides of the lower recessed frame regions from the central region, the lower raised frame regions defined by regions of the lower electrode having a greater thickness than a thickness of the lower electrode in the central region, the dielectric material layer extending throughout the lower raised frame regions and having a thickness in the lower raised frame regions less than the thickness of the dielectric material layer in the central region.

17. The film bulk acoustic wave resonator of claim 16 wherein the lower recessed frame regions are defined by regions of one of the dielectric material layer having a lesser thickness than the thickness of the dielectric material layer in the central region or of the lower electrode having a lesser thickness than a thickness of the lower electrode in the central region.
